YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Muffin

P G D N

A simple, reliable frame, your kid picks the mix-ins.

YOUR CODE

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Planner

G — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Gardener

D — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Doer

N — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Nester

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Last Warm Plate

At dinner, everyone has a preference. One child wants sauce on the side, another wants the blue cup, and someone asks for more rice just as you finally sit down. You say “sure” so many times that your own food goes cold. When you suddenly snap over a spilled spoon, guilt arrives before the apology: Why am I angry when nobody asked for much?

As a Muffin parent, you make a dependable container. You make room, offer choices, and rarely ask to be the center. But needs do not disappear because they are quiet; they wait until exhaustion gives them a louder voice.



You warm your plate and say, without apologizing, “I'm eating first. Please give me five minutes.” The room survives. Nobody's love shrinks.

When you return to the spilled spoon, you say, “I was tired and spoke sharply. That wasn't your fault.” Your child helps wipe the table. That evening, the family learns something bigger than generosity: home is not a place where one person disappears to keep everyone comfortable. It is where everybody, including you, gets to exist.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You offer choices, keep the atmosphere calm, and rarely demand the spotlight. Your own needs can disappear from view until you are exhausted or suddenly irritated.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Having needs does not make you selfish. Saying “I need this too” creates more honesty than giving in repeatedly and then exploding.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. Low-drama consistency, every single day
2. Quietly empowering, "you choose" is your catchphrase
3. Comfort your kid can count on

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

"Easygoing" can hide your own needs. Muffins need care too, that's you. 🧁

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Panda parenting



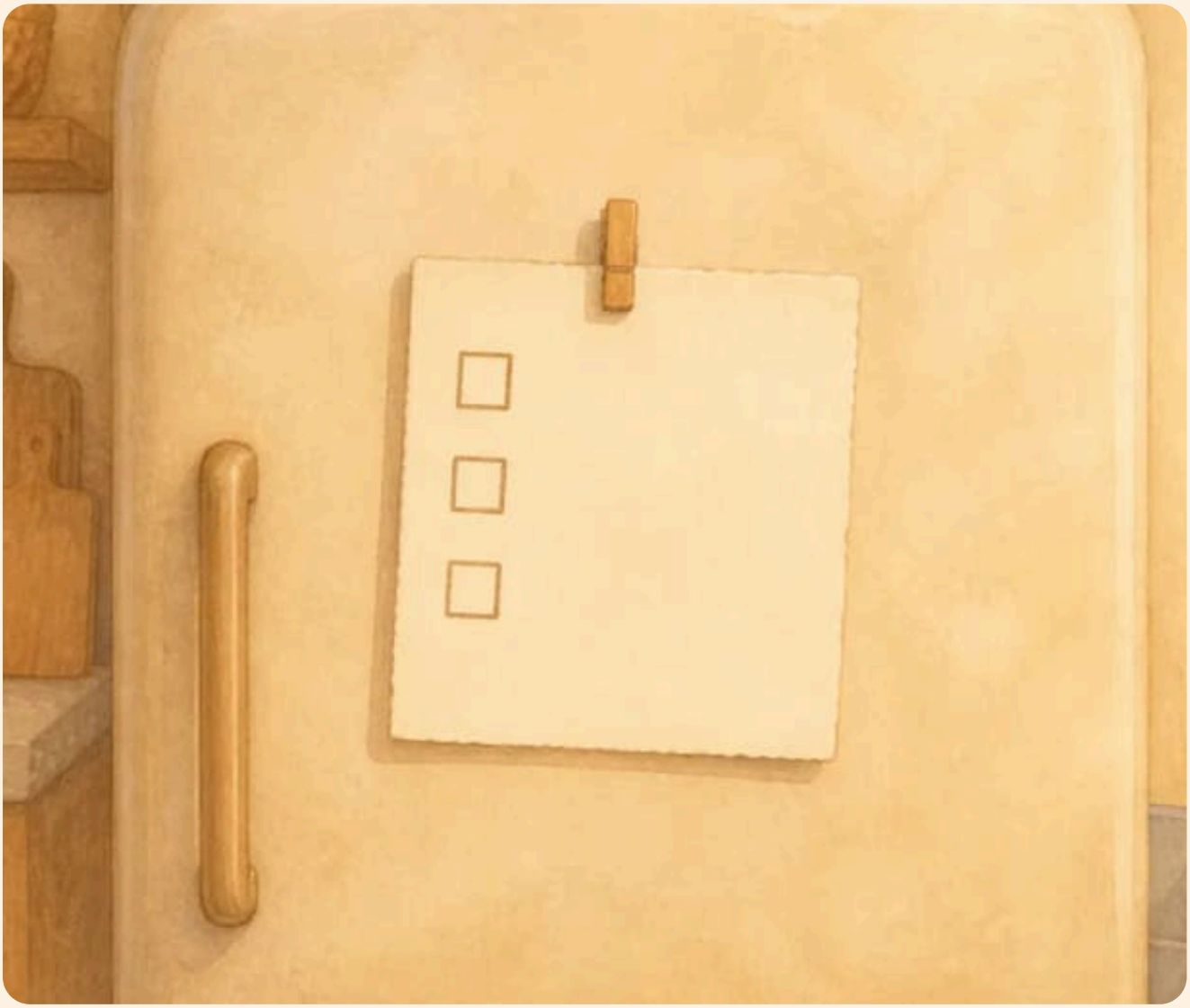
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Choose something you genuinely want
- [ ] Ask for one specific form of help
- [ ] Say: “I love you, and I need five minutes alone now.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Start one day this week with no list at all.
- [ ] Once this week, decide without offering a choice.
- [ ] Ask once: "Do you want a hug, or a minute first?"
- [ ] Hold back one "be careful" today.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

P

HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Anticipating. Your head keeps running even when your body sits down.

G

WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Waiting and holding back. Following someone else's pace all day is work.

D

WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Doing. Loving through action means you rarely get to sit down.

N

COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Vigilance. Everyone's sense of safety is parked with you.

FOR YOU FIRST

State one small preference each day without apologizing for having it.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 2 MIN

One unplanned thing

Not to train spontaneity. Just small proof to yourself that a moment off-plan is survivable.

Do one small thing today that was on no list. A different route home, an unscheduled snack.



TIME 5 MIN

Rehearse one limit sentence

Following the child still needs a floor under it. A limit is easier to say once you've heard it in your own voice.

Say one clear limit out loud, alone, until it sounds normal: "Not today." "I need ten minutes."



TIME 2 MIN

Leave one thing undone

Not laziness — practice. If one thing can wait a night and the morning still arrives, your edges get a little more room.

Pick one thing tonight and deliberately leave it: the dishes, the toy basket, the reply.



TIME 2 MIN

One last check, then say "enough"

Worry keeps reopening the same loop. A small ritual that closes it works better than telling yourself to stop.

Do the check once. Then say the word out loud: enough.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Your child learns that family is not only where their needs are received, but where everyone considers one another.



0–12 MONTHS · 5 MIN

Peekaboo, with a scarf

The oldest turn-taking game there is, played at your baby's pace instead of yours.

1. Drape a light scarf over your own face, not theirs.
2. Wait for their sound or reach before you reveal.
3. Stop the moment they look away — that's them saying done.

You'll need: One light, breathable scarf.
Safety first: The scarf goes over you, never the baby. Never leave fabric on or near a baby's face.
Grounded in: Serve and return (Harvard)



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

Move the water with a sponge

The water does the correcting, not you. The spill is part of the activity, not a failure of it.

1. Set two shallow bowls on a towel, one with a little water.
2. Show the squeeze once.
3. Put a small cloth beside them and let them mop it themselves.

You'll need: Two shallow bowls, one small sponge, a towel, a cloth.
Safety first: A very small amount of water, always within arm's reach. A toddler can drown in a few centimetres.
Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



2–3 YEARS · 15 MIN

Build the calm basket together

Assembling the box while nobody is upset works far better than looking for it mid-meltdown.

1. Offer a basket and ask what helps when their feelings get big.
2. Put in whatever they say, even if it seems useless to you.
3. Name the feelings that come up as you talk, without fixing them.

You'll need: A basket, plus their choices: a soft toy, a picture, a squeeze ball, a blanket.

Safety first: Every loose item must be too large for a toilet-paper tube. Nothing that can be tied, wrapped, or pulled over the head.

Grounded in: Play therapy — reflecting feelings



3–4 YEARS · 15 MIN

Give the toys a bath

Real work with real water — exactly how Doer parents love, and children this age will stay with it for a long time.

1. A basin of warm water, a soft brush, a towel.
2. They wash, you wash beside them without supervising the quality.
3. When they say a toy is clean, it's clean.

You'll need: A basin, warm water, a soft brush, a towel, washable toys.

Safety first: Shallow water, never unattended. No electronic toys.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



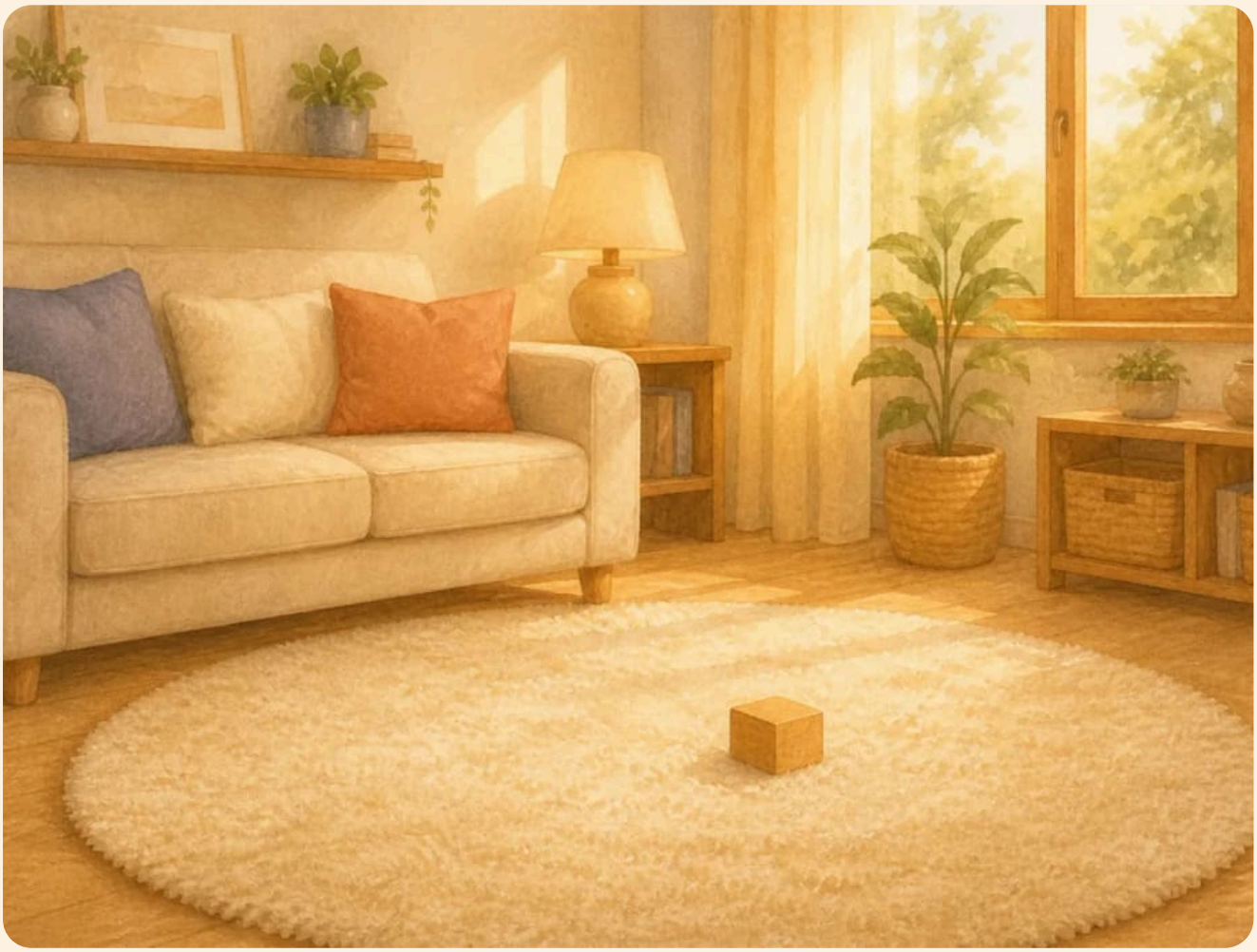
4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

One real step in the cooking

Not pretend cooking. One genuine step of the meal the family actually eats, done by them.

1. Choose one safe step: tearing lettuce, peeling a banana, spreading butter, stirring off the heat.
2. Give them the real tool, child-sized if you have one.
3. At the table, say out loud which part they made.

You'll need: Whatever you're already cooking.
Safety first: Nothing at the stove, nothing sharp, nothing hot. Hands washed, and an adult stays in the kitchen.
Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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